

AI alone is becoming a weaker differentiator before Dutch GTM scales.

EVIDENCE AXIS INFERENCE

Exact is embedding agent automation at installed-base scale. Qonto and Shine/Cegid are consolidating adjacent finance workflows in the Netherlands. The harder boundary to defend is the finished outcome.

100K+

company administrations using Exact Purchase Agent

Independent executive interview [E2]

100M+

bank transactions monitored monthly by Exact Bank Agent

Exact primary source [E1]

NL LIVE

Qonto and Shine both verified in the Dutch market

Independent + legal/product evidence [Q1,S3-S6]

Scope: public evidence only. Neno company claims are treated as primary-source context unless independently verified.

Why this matters now

Neno is moving from product proof into market execution.

NENO'S OWN DECISION QUESTION

“Who are we taking share from today? And where can we draw more from?”

Nick Knuppe, Neno company update, 25 Aug 2026
[N1]

25 AUG

€6.6M Seed



Round led by AlleyCorp.

Q4 2026

Scale Dutch GTM



Commercial team, localized GTM, partner integrations.

H2 2027

Expand in Europe



Netherlands first: win, defend, prove repeatability.

The competitive question needs to be answered before GTM spend scales, not after.

[N1] Neno, company update, 25 Aug 2026.

Finding A — Exact is closing the easy part of the gap

The incumbent is no longer a static “legacy software” reference point.

PRIMARY + INDEPENDENT PROOF

100K+

company administrations
using Purchase Agent

Independent: Exact CPO interview [E2]

10K+

administrations using
Debtor Agent

Independent: Exact CPO interview [E2]

100M+

bank transactions
monitored per month

Exact primary source [E1]

Exact publicly names four AI agents inside accounting: Purchase, Bank, Support and Debtor. [E1]

What changed

Agent-level automation is already embedded in invoice processing, bank matching and receivables workflows — with meaningful installed-base usage, not only launch copy.

DECISION IMPLICATION

**“AI-native vs legacy”
is becoming a weaker
sales shorthand.**

Exact is already automating the workflows Neno wants to displace. The stronger contrast must sit above task automation.

Candidate boundary to defend:

**owned ledger + finished work
+ accountable human review**

[E1] Exact accounting product page. [E2] ICT Magazine interview with Exact CPO Joep Hoeks.

Finding B — the back-office bundle is being attacked from the other side

Qonto and Shine/Cegid do not need to become Neno to raise the customer baseline.

QONTO — ADJACENT CONVERGENCE		SHINE / CEGID — DUTCH BOUNDARY PRESSURE	
600K+	SME + freelance customers across Europe	1M+	SMBs served by the combined group across Europe after closing. [S1,S2]
Netherlands	Live market; business banking + cards + bookkeeping tools + expense management + short-term financing in one hub. [Q1,Q5]	Netherlands	Shine is independently listed/reviewed as Dutch bookkeeping software; its NL product covers invoicing, bookkeeping, VAT and payroll. [S3,S5,S6]
AI layer	Operator + Analyst are integrated in Dutch accounts and available across all plans/users. [Q2]	Group direction	Cegid + Shine combine accounting, e-invoicing, payments/accounts, tax, HR and payroll. [S1,S2]
Guardrail	Acasi adds certified accounting in France. Current evidence does not establish that service in the Netherlands. [Q4]	Guardrail	Shine says it is not the customer's accountant/tax adviser; Dutch accounting scope has explicit limitations. [S4]

Pressure mechanism: adjacent platforms can compress parts of Neno's bundle without matching its full service/accountability layer.

[Q1-Q5] Qonto evidence. [S1-S6] Shine/Cegid evidence. See Appendix for source classes and guardrails.

The overlap is real — but it is not symmetric

The reviewed public evidence points to one boundary that competitors have not matched in the Netherlands.

Capability	Neno	Exact	Qonto	Shine / Cegid
Accounting / bookkeeping core	YES	YES	PARTIAL	YES
Named AI agents	YES	YES	YES	NOT EST.
Business account / payments	YES	PARTIAL	YES	PARTIAL
Payroll in the finance stack	YES	YES	NOT EST.	YES
In-house accountant review	YES	NOT EST.	NOT EST. NL	NO
Done-for-you compliance / reporting	YES	NOT EST.	NOT EST. NL	PARTIAL
Owned real-time ledger + service layer	YES	PARTIAL	NOT EST.	NOT EST.

Legend:

YES

confirmed in reviewed public evidence

PARTIAL

adjacent / narrower / group-level

NOT EST.

not established in reviewed scope

Neno column is based on Neno primary-source claims. Matrix is a scope map, not a feature-completeness score.

Sources: [N1], [E1-E2], [Q1-Q5], [S1-S6]. Evidence Axis synthesis; see Appendix for boundaries.

The moat to defend is the outcome layer

Public evidence suggests the differentiation stack is moving upward.

1

AI / task automation

Converging quickly

Exact and Qonto already expose named agent automation.

2

Integrated finance workflow

Converging

Qonto and Shine/Cegid are broadening the bundle around the SME back office.

3

Finished outcome + accountability

Still differentiated in reviewed NL evidence

Neno says it owns the real-time ledger, has in-house accountants approve output, and delivers a done-for-you state of work.

GTM IMPLICATION

1 POSITION

Lead with finished work, system ownership and accountable service — not AI as the headline.

2 BATTLECARD

Force the comparison from “who automates tasks?” to “who owns completion?”

3 WATCH

Monitor Qonto accounting-service localization and Shine/Cegid’s Dutch service boundary.

Evidence Axis inference from reviewed public evidence. This is a positioning hypothesis to test against win/loss and pipeline data.

Three questions worth answering before Q4 spend scales

The public evidence answers “what is moving.” Internal Neno data is needed to answer “what should we do?”

01

Which Dutch buyers switch for finished work — not feature automation?

Test by segment using pipeline, lost deals, churn reasons and sales-call evidence.

02

Which competitive claim survives a side-by-side sales test?

Build a battlecard against Exact, Qonto and Shine using real objections and proof, not category language.

03

Which 2027 market has the cleanest decision advantage?

Score UK, Belgium, Italy and Spain on localization burden, incumbent strength, platform convergence and buyer pain.

If useful, Evidence Axis can turn this public-evidence brief into a Competitive Decision Sprint using Neno’s pipeline, lost deals and market priorities.

The brief is complete on its own; the sprint answers the company-specific response question.